

“The feeling for me was more intense during the approach to the beach than the beach itself. Would I be coming back, or would my life be snuffed out?”

Lance Corporal William Bleakley, 1st Can. Regiment

“You’re in the water now. In the breakers. You try to remember how to move. Smoke up ahead, and the noise... It’s like nothing you’ve ever heard before. We were told to not stop and help any of our buddies as we too might be hit”

Wilfred Bennett, Royal Winnipeg Rifles

“I was the eleventh off the landing craft. The first eight were all killed, and two more were wounded. I was shot in the hand. A potato masher (German grenade) landed in front of me. I tossed it back over the wall.

Ralph Jackson, Queen’s Own Rifles of Canada

“All day and all night, the guns blasting the way for fighting men.
Millions of shells helping to win this close, bloody and ferocious
battle in Normandy...”

Matthew Halton, reporting for CBC Radio

“My Dear Mr. And Mrs Duncan:

It is with my deepest regret that I have to write you this letter.
Your son, my Platoon Commander, met with an accident which
proved fatal... I can say with great pride, that he will always be
remembered by his boys and myself. We buried him in an orchard.
In a good a grave as is permitted under these conditions. I must
close now with regret of the whole platoon on your sad
bereavement.

Yours,

Sergeant M. Brimble

[Omaha](#)